SKINCU COLOR CHANGING LIPSTICK

PART 1 | HOOKS

Three openers. All run to 00:07 and hand over to the shared body at 00:08.

HOOK A | Original

CLIP / TIME	SCRIPT
00:00	
00:00	**EMMA:** Mom. He's here.
00:02	**LINDA:** Okay.
00:03	**EMMA:** Mom. He brought her.
00:05	**LINDA:** In my driveway?
00:06	**EMMA:** She's sitting in the car.

The source opening. Six lines, no context, and by the fifth second there is a woman sitting in somebody else's driveway. Highest tension of the three and the control.

HOOK B | Did you have them done

CLIP / TIME	SCRIPT
00:00	
00:00	**RAY:** Linda. You look really good.
00:04	**RAY:** Did you have them done?
00:06	**LINDA:** No. Boxes are by the door.

Opens on the payoff instead of the setup. The viewer meets her after the change and spends the film finding out what he is looking at. Strongest of the three for a cold audience because the compliment and the brush off both land inside seven seconds.

HOOK C | You let yourself go

CLIP / TIME	SCRIPT
00:00	
00:00	**RAY:** You don't look like the woman I married. You let yourself go.
00:05	**EMMA:** Eight weeks later he couldn't stop looking at her on our driveway.

Opens on the knife. Hardest hook in the library and the one most likely to stop a 45 plus woman dead, because a lot of them have heard a version of it. Handle with care in the comments.

PART 2 | MAIN SCRIPT (SHARED BODY)

Runs identically under all three hooks. Total runtime with any hook, roughly 3:02.

CLIP / TIME	SCRIPT
00:08	**EMMA:** He came back for his boxes expecting the same woman he walked out on eight weeks before.

CLIP / TIME	SCRIPT
00:15	*ACTION: Driveway. He stops halfway up it and actually looks at her.*
00:15	**RAY:** Linda. You look really good.
00:19	**RAY:** Did you have them done?
00:21	**LINDA:** No. Boxes are by the door.
00:24	**EMMA:** Eight weeks before.
00:26	*ACTION: Flashback. Kitchen, evening.*
00:26	**RAY:** You don't look like the woman I married. You let yourself go. I'm not attracted to you.
00:34	**EMMA:** She was twenty nine. His colleague. Four years older than me.
00:39	*ACTION: Bathroom, that night. Linda at the mirror. Emma in the doorway.*
00:39	**LINDA:** What is wrong with my face? Tell me the truth.
00:44	**EMMA:** There's nothing wrong with your face.
00:46	**LINDA:** I can't be loved looking like this.
00:49	**EMMA:** How much of it did you buy this month?
00:52	**LINDA:** Don't.
00:53	**EMMA:** I'm not judging you. I'm asking.
00:56	**LINDA:** Four. The one with the little gold lid. The expensive French one. A liner I never used.
01:04	**LINDA:** None of it stays where I put it. By ten in the morning it's in every line I've got.
01:11	**LINDA:** And I look tired. All day, I look tired.
01:15	*ACTION: A hallway. Emma knocking on a neighbour's door. Miss Kim, Korean, sixties, a professor.*
01:15	**EMMA:** Miss Kim. Can I ask you something completely inappropriate?
01:19	**MISS KIM:** Those are the good ones.
01:21	**EMMA:** What's on your mouth? You've been talking all evening and it hasn't moved.
01:27	**EMMA:** My mom's mouth is breaking her heart and I don't know how to help her.
01:33	**MISS KIM:** What she keeps buying has one fixed colour in it, picked by somebody who never met her. So it sits on top of her, and it crawls into every line she has.
01:45	**MISS KIM:** This one has no colour in it at all. It reads the pH of her own lips and builds the shade out of that. Then it binds, so there's nowhere for it to go.
01:56	**MISS KIM:** It isn't paint. There's nothing to crack.
01:59	**EMMA:** Will it work on her?
02:01	**MISS KIM:** Let her put it on tonight. And stand next to her when she does.
02:06	*ACTION: Bathroom, late. Linda in her dressing gown, exhausted, no fight left in her.*
02:06	**EMMA:** Twenty seconds. That's the whole thing.
02:09	*ACTION: She draws it on. It goes on completely clear. She looks at Emma as if this is a joke.*
02:09	**LINDA:** I look ridiculous.
02:11	**EMMA:** Just wait.

CLIP / TIME	SCRIPT
02:13	*ACTION: Hold on her mouth. The colour builds out of it. Emma sees it first.*
02:17	**EMMA:** Mom. Go and look at yourself.
02:20	*ACTION: Linda at the mirror. Close on her mouth. The lines around it are clearly visible, and the colour is not sitting in any of them.*
02:20	**LINDA:** Where did that come from?
02:23	**EMMA:** Out of you.
02:25	**LINDA:** The lines are still there.
02:27	**EMMA:** They are. They're yours and they're staying. It just isn't in them any more.
02:33	*ACTION: Driveway, present day. Ray at the boxes. Behind him, the girlfriend in the car, checking her own mouth in the visor mirror.*
02:33	**RAY:** Linda, can I ask you something?
02:36	**LINDA:** They're by the door, Ray.
02:38	**RAY:** Was that her?
02:40	**GIRLFRIEND:** She looks good.
02:42	**RAY:** She looks fine.
02:43	**GIRLFRIEND:** Is this light weird?
02:45	**RAY:** You look fine.
02:46	**GIRLFRIEND:** You keep saying that.
02:49	**EMMA:** He never looked at her once on that driveway.
02:53	*ON SCREEN: Skincu Color Changing Lipstick. Buy one get one free. 30 day guarantee. Over 127,000 women over 40.*
02:53	**EMMA:** He didn't stop seeing her. She stopped seeing herself.
02:57	**EMMA:** And the second she saw herself again, she didn't need him to look at all.

RESTORED LINES | takes it to about 3:28

Seven lines cut only for runtime. Each one goes back in at the timecode shown, and the film is better with them if you have the room.

CLIP / TIME	SCRIPT
00:14	**EMMA:** He made her wait in the car. Like that made it politer.
00:48	**EMMA:** And I knew exactly what she meant. I'd known for about three years and I could never say it out loud.
01:14	**LINDA:** Hundreds of dollars trying to look like somebody he'd stay for.
01:18	**EMMA:** Mom.
01:19	**LINDA:** I know. I know how that sounds.
02:05	**EMMA:** Miss Kim, she's fragile right now. If this doesn't work I think it might actually break her.
02:12	**LINDA:** Emma, I'm tired. I don't want to do this.

THE DEB SCENE | cut from the main, written in full

Drops in between 02:32 and the driveway return, and adds about twenty seconds. The source used it to prove her bare skin looked better. Ours proves something better than that, which is that the colour reads as her own mouth to somebody who has known her for years.

CLIP / TIME	SCRIPT
+0:00	*ACTION: A street, weeks later. A friend stops dead on the pavement.*
+0:00	**DEB:** Okay, stop. Stop walking.
+0:02	**LINDA:** Deb?
+0:03	**DEB:** What are you doing? Your mouth. You're not even wearing anything.
+0:08	**LINDA:** I am, actually.
+0:10	**DEB:** No you're not.
+0:11	**LINDA:** I promise you I am.
+0:13	**DEB:** Then what is it? Because that's just your mouth.
+0:17	**EMMA:** That's the point. That is her mouth. It always was.

It also works on its own as a fifteen second cut for retargeting, with the end card straight after the last line.

PRODUCTION NOTES

- The whole film rests on one unbroken shot at 02:09. Clear going on, then the colour building, no cut. If you cut there, the film has no proof in it at all and nothing else in the edit can rescue that.
- At 02:20 shoot her mouth honestly, no diffusion, no soft light. The lines have to be clearly visible or the line at 02:27 is a lie.
- Play Ray ordinary, not cruel. He should sound like he is being reasonable. That is what makes the flashback land and it is also what makes him pathetic at 02:38.
- The girlfriend never gets a close up and never gets out of the car. We see her through a windscreen checking a visor mirror and that is all. The second she becomes a character the ending stops working.
- Emma narrates in past tense from somewhere else, not from inside the scenes. Keep her voice flat. The material is doing the work.
- Keep every prop unbranded. The four tubes at 00:56 are spoken about and never shown, which is deliberate.
- Confirm the offer against the live lander before this ships. Thirty days, buy one get one free, no price anywhere unless the lander shows one.
- Caption suggestion for the platform: He came back for his boxes and could not stop looking at her. She had been wearing it for one night.